reinforced by Firuzkuh's mercantile economy and connectivity with the cosmopolitan cultural geography of greater Khurasan *via* Herat, the age-old commercial emporium and politico-cultural center, whence the routes of communication branched out to the east and north (cf. Introduction and Chapter 2).[98] Firuzkuh's westward links had distinguished its eponymous appanage from that of Bamiyan since the days of 'Ala' al-Din *Jahan-suz*, for example, in the many important military campaigns that could be undertaken with a consistently replenished treasury, in addition to the marital alliances with neighboring regions (cf. Chapter 4). A third imperial lineage at Ghazna, initiated as of the mid-1170s with Shihab al-Din's crowning as Sultan Mu'izz al-Din there, garnered great notoriety with their spectacular victories in India (cf. Chapters 5 and 6, and Volume II).

All the principal and minor Shansabani lineages were interrelated and also intermarried; but, as underscored here, each was increasingly independent and adaptive to its respective base of power. Indeed, this very responsiveness to particularized circumstances was a *modus vivendi* arguably deriving from the Shansabanis' earlier transhumance, or physical and affective mobility between nomadic and sedentist lifeworlds. The respective Shansabani lineages established at Firuzkuh, Bamiyan, and eventually Ghazna responded to and helped to shape their regional specificities, constituting yet another glimpse of "the organization talent [*sic*], cosmopolitanism, pragmatism, adaptation, and integration ability of … nomadic societies".[99]

Notes

1. For a distillation of bibliographic references, see Ball 2019: 468.
2. Based on comparisons with firmly identified coinage and other factors (e.g., invocations of Baghdad *khalifa*s), O'Neal (2016b) has attributed several previously unexamined coins of 'Ala' al-Din Husain to the Ghazna mint *c.* AH 555/1160 CE. This attribution would indicate that Ala al-Din again successfully took the city and considered it a part of his domains before the Oghüz occupation of the 1160s. Cf. *infra* in main text.
3. Remarkably, it appears that the *re*occupation of Ghaznavid-patronized palatial and other structures at Ghazna and Bust-Lashkari Bazar by Shihab al-Din – properly called Mu'izz al-Din after his installation and crowning at Ghazna – and his *ghulam*s was not inconsequential: the palatial architecture attributable to the period of early Shansabani establishment in northern India *c.*1192–1200 has much in common especially with precedents at Lashkari Bazar, probably signaling the increasing habitation of built structures – rather than the "textile architecture" of before – at least by the Ghazna branch of the Shansabanis and their *ghulam*s. See esp. Chapter 5.
4. See *infra* (main text and notes) for a discussion of Nizami 'Aruzi's *Chahar Maqala* and its importance for contextual information regarding the Firuzkuh